

SUBSECTION S3 · STANDALONE COURSE

Inclusive Gamification

Game-based learning that works for every learner

What this course is

A standalone course on designing game-based learning that includes the learners who are usually left out: special-needs, mixed-ability, and neurodivergent students. It is Kevin Storm's signature strength, built on years of real work in special education, from stop-motion with multiple-disability learners to high-autonomy classrooms.

Half a day live, or self-paced. It assumes only that you have, or want, a gamified lesson to make inclusive.

KEY POINT

Promise: leave able to design and adapt game-based lessons so that no learner is a spectator, without lowering the bar for anyone.

Who it is for

- Special education (SO/VSO), inclusive and mixed-ability mainstream classrooms.
- Any teacher with learners who "check out" of normal lessons.
- Schools and boards professionalising their teams around inclusion.

The core idea

Inclusion is not a bolt-on you add at the end. A game that already offers **choice, adjustable challenge and non-verbal ways to succeed** is inclusive by design. This course teaches you to build that in from the start, using Universal Design for Learning (UDL) as the backbone: multiple means of engagement, representation and expression.

Learning outcomes

By the end, participants can:

1. Spot who a given game excludes, and why.
2. Apply six inclusion moves to any gamified lesson.
3. Design non-verbal and multi-path success so every learner can win.
4. Manage sensory load, pace and predictability in game-based activities.
5. Balance collaboration and competition so competition never crushes anyone.
6. Use creative media (stop-motion, photography, building) as inclusive game mechanics.

The six inclusion moves

STEP

1. Adjustable challenge, an easy path and a hard path to the same goal.

STEP

2. Non-verbal success, a way to win that does not depend on words.

STEP

3. Choice as self-regulation, let learners pick task, pace or role.

STEP

4. Sensory control, a calmer option; manage sound, motion, overload.

STEP

5. Collaboration over competition, team goals; shared, not zero-sum, wins.

STEP

6. Predictable structure, clear steps, visible progress, no nasty surprises.

Session plan (half day, ~3 hours)

Part 1 · Who gets left out, and why (45 min)

- Walk a normal gamified lesson through the eyes of your hardest-to-reach learner.
- Name the barriers: reading load, speed, competition, sensory overload, unpredictability.

Part 2 · The six moves, applied (75 min)

- Teach each move with a real example.
- Hands-on: take one gamified lesson and rebuild it with at least three moves

(Worksheet: the inclusion grid).

ASSIGNMENT

Take a game-based lesson you use (or one from the flagship course) and redesign it so your most-easily-excluded learner can fully take part and succeed. Name the three moves you used.

Part 3 · Creative media as inclusive mechanics (40 min)

- Stop-motion, photography and building as game elements: success is visible, non-verbal, and paced by the learner.

- Kevin's case stories from special education.

Part 4 · Make it routine (20 min)

- An inclusion checklist you run over every game-based lesson before you teach it.
- How to coach colleagues to do the same.

The inclusion checklist (take-away)

Before you run any game-based lesson, check:

- Can a learner succeed without reading a lot or speaking?
- Is there an easier and a harder path to the same goal?
- Is there a calmer option if the game is too much?
- Does anyone lose publicly in a way that could shame them?
- Is the structure clear: goal, steps, visible progress?
- Is there a real choice the learner controls?

Why this course matters commercially

- Rare. Most gamification training ignores inclusion; this leads with it.
- Funded. It maps onto special-education budgets and the basisvaardigheden / passend-onderwijs money.
- Trusted. It comes from someone who has actually taught these learners.

Sources

- Universal Design for Learning (UDL / CAST), the engagement, representation, expression framework.
- Self-Determination Theory, autonomy, competence, relatedness.
- Kevin Storm's special-education practice (SO/VSO, mytyl/EMB, high-autonomy settings).